



Let's Practice!

Natural disasters can devastate cities, communities and Natural Wonders*.

The magnitude** of the disaster is still being calculated***.

*The Great Barrier Reef is the largest coral reef in the world.

**The size, extent, or importance of something.

***General idea about the value, size, or cost of something.

Instructions: Match the phrases on the right with the ones on the left to form sentences. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

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|---|--|
| 1. Numerous communities in eastern Australia were | a. devastated by massive flooding in the early hours of January 10th. |
| 2. In one small town, panicked citizens were | b. forced to evacuate to their rooftops by a tsunami-like flash flood. |
| 3. The floods were caused by the hot ocean | c. water off the coast of Australia. |
| 4. As water temperatures continue to rise, the atmosphere was | d. filled with water vapor. |



Let's Practice!

The author makes a number of observations* regarding the violent weather and subsequent** reactions.

*An "observation" is a statement about something you have noticed.

**"Subsequent" means happening or coming after something else.

Instructions: Read the statements. Complete them by choosing an option from the box. Read the sentences aloud. Compare your answers to your partner's answers. Correct each other.

If we all / Shouldn't / there would've been / they should start / leaders could enact

- _____ work together, we will create change.
- _____ we as global a society feel compelled to do more to combat global warming?
- If the local emergency response teams had not been prepared with lifeboats and helicopters, _____ a significant loss of life.
- They have suggested to the government that _____ redirecting polluted water away from this sensitive area.
- With the support of citizens, _____ laws that would protect future generations.